

PUCK

FIRST APPEARANCE Alpha Flight Vol. 1 #1 (August 1983)
REAL NAME Eugene Milton Judd
OCCUPATION Alpha Flight member **BASE** Tamarind Island
HEIGHT 3 ft 6 in **WEIGHT** 225 lbs **EYES** Brown **HAIR** Black
SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES Superb athlete and gymnast; formidable hand-to-hand combatant with unique fighting style; trained bullfighter; limited knowledge of sorcery.

Eugene Judd released the evil sorcerer Black Raazer and managed to trap him in his own body, which extended his life but reduced him to the height of a dwarf. Judd was later invited to join Beta and then Alpha Flight as Puck. He eventually rid himself of Black Raazer, temporarily costing him his powers. Later, Puck's daughter Zuzha Yu joined a new Alpha Flight, calling herself Puck too. They both died trying to stop the Collective, a man imbued with all of the mutant energies lost on M-Day. **AD, MF**



PUMA

FIRST APPEARANCE Amazing Spider-Man Vol. 1 #256 (Sept. 1984)
REAL NAME Thomas Fireheart
OCCUPATION CEO of Fireheart Enterprises; mercenary
BASE Mobile **HEIGHT** 6 ft 2 in **WEIGHT** 240 lbs
EYES Green **HAIR** Red; (as Fireheart) black
SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES As Puma Fireheart has superhuman strength, agility, heightened senses, and claws

Puma was the heir to a long tradition of mystical champions created by a Native American tribe. Raised to oppose the BEYONDER, Thomas Fireheart donned the mantle of the Puma and kept his fighting skills sharp by becoming a mercenary, often fighting (or aiding) SPIDER-MAN. Fireheart also served as the head of Fireheart Enterprises, which supplied him with high-tech weaponry and vehicles, but he constantly struggled to control his animalistic Puma persona. After the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), he was accused of taking bribes and joined Modok to make money to pay for his defense. **MF**



PUNISHER

War hero turned vengeful vigilante

Marine Captain Frank Castle was a decorated hero during the Vietnam War. Winner of the Bronze and Silver Star, and recipient of four Purple Hearts, Castle was an exceptionally skilled combat veteran. Then came the event that changed his life. While on leave in New York, Castle took his family for a picnic in Central Park. There they witnessed a mob murder. The mobsters then killed Castle's wife and two young children.



Frank Castle, family man, in happier days.

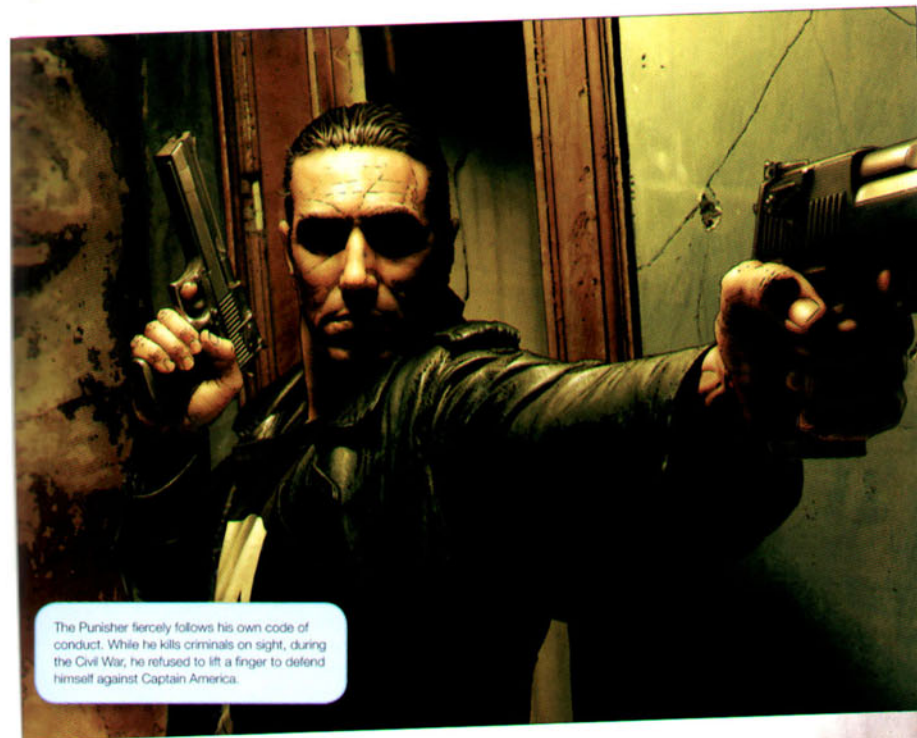
ONE-MAN ARMY

With his whole world destroyed, Castle deserted from the Marines and dropped out of sight for a few months. When he resurfaced, it was as a vigilante named the Punisher, who conducted a one-man, anti-crime campaign throughout New York City. Equipped with an arsenal of weapons, the Punisher took his vengeance on the mob gang who had killed his family, but he didn't stop there. He vowed to kill all criminals of every kind.

The Punisher has devoted his life to destroying organized crime, drug dealers, street gangs, muggers, killers, or any other criminal element. His actions have brought him into conflict with several costumed heroes, such as SPIDER-MAN (with whom he has also cooperated), and DAREDEVIL, who strictly opposes Punisher's lethal methods.



The big white skull on Punisher's costume draws criminal fire to his heavily armored body rather than to his unprotected head.



The Punisher fiercely follows his own code of conduct. While he kills criminals on sight, during the Civil War, he refused to lift a finger to defend himself against Captain America.



ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• Marvel Preview #2

Marine captain Frank Castle takes his wife and two children for a picnic in New York's Central Park. There, they witness a mob killing, after which the mobsters kill Castle's wife and children. Traumatized, Castle takes vengeance against the killers and continues his one-man vigilante campaign against all criminals as the Punisher.

• The Punisher Vol. 1 Welcome Back, Frank (tpb)

After a long absence, the Punisher returns to the streets of Manhattan to take on Ma Grucci and her crime family.

WEAPONS AND ENEMIES

To carry out his war on crime, the Punisher uses machine guns, rifles, handguns, shotguns, knives, grenade launchers, armor-piercing bullets, and explosives. His weapons are customized with tactical scopes, night-vision scopes, silencers, and tripods.

During the Civil War (see pp. 84-5), the Punisher specifically targeted Super Villains. In the aftermath of the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326-7), he has dedicated himself to killing one of the most powerful Super Villains in the world: Norman Osborn (see GREEN GOBLIN). **MT, MF**

Evil beware! On the streets of Manhattan, no one escapes the Punisher's vigilante vengeance!



When Spider-Man was on the run after switching sides during the Civil War, the Punisher stepped in to save him.

FACTFILE

REAL NAME

Frank Castle (born Castiglione)

OCCUPATION

Vigilante

BASE

Mobile

HEIGHT

6 ft 1 in

WEIGHT

200 lbs

EYES

Blue

HAIR

Black

FIRST APPEARANCE

Amazing Spider-Man #129

(February 1974)

The Punisher is seasoned combat veteran of exceptional skill. He has undergone SEAL (Sea, Air, Land), UDT (Underwater Demolition Team), and LRPA (Long Range Patrol) military training. He is an expert using all types of small arms and large caliber guns, he has extensive training using explosives and tactical weapons, and he is a superior martial artist and hand-to-hand combatant.